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ANSWERS AND KEYWORDS HIGHLIGHTED

Tea in Sri Lanka (GE Reading Paper 4): Teacher copy

20 minutes. Yellow = where the answer is. Pink = keyword in the question and the matching words in the passage (same small number). Blue tag = question number and answer.

Tea in Sri Lanka

[A] Tea is one of the most important things that Sri Lanka sells to other countries. Every day, millions of cups of Ceylon **tea**[6] are drunk around the world. Many people think that tea has always grown on the island, but this is not true. Tea is **quite new**[6] in Sri Lanka **6: FALSE** , and the story of how it began is a surprising one. It is a story about a failed crop, a brave young farmer and a lot of hard work.

[B] In the early 1800s, farmers in the hills of Sri Lanka grew coffee, not tea. Coffee made a lot of money for the island, and many people moved to the hills to work on the farms. However, in the 1860s a **disease**[7] began to kill the **coffee plants**[7] **7: TRUE** . The leaves turned orange and fell off, and the farmers could not stop it. Within about twenty years, nearly all of the **coffee farms**[14] had **failed**[14] **14: B** . Many farmers lost their land, and the **island**[1] needed a **new crop**[1] very quickly **1: B** . This was a very hard time for the island.

[C] A **Scottish**[8] farmer **called James Taylor**[289] **8: TRUE** found the answer. He came to Sri Lanka in 1852 when he was only seventeen years old. At first he worked on a coffee farm, like everyone else. Then, in 1867, he **planted the first tea**[2] on a small piece of land near the city of Kandy **2: C** . He learned how to make the **tea**[9] by himself, and he did the work by hand in his own house. He often worked from early morning until late at night. The tea was very good **9: NOT GIVEN** . Soon other farmers saw what he had done, and they began to plant tea too.

[D] The **hills**[4] were a perfect place for this new crop. **Tea grows**[4] best in places that are cool and wet **4: D** , and the hills of Sri Lanka have plenty of rain and fresh air. The green tea bushes cover the hillsides like a soft carpet. Workers called **pluckers**[11] walk between the bushes every day. They pick only the **youngest leaves**[11] and a bud **11: bud** , because these give the best taste. Most of the pluckers are women, and they carry large baskets on their backs. **Machines**[10] cannot do this job well **15: C** , so people still **pick**[1015] the leaves **by hand**[15] **10: FALSE** .

[E] After the leaves are picked, they go to a **factory**[3], and the **work**[3] there has four main steps **3: E** . First, the leaves lie in **large**[12] rooms for **many hours**[12] **12: rooms** so that they lose water. Second, they are rolled to break them open, which lets the juice come out. Third, the leaves are left for a short time and turn dark brown, and this change gives the tea its strong smell and colour. Finally, hot air dries the leaves completely. The dry tea is then sorted by size, put into bags and sent to Colombo, where it is sold at an **auction**[13] **13: Colombo** .

[F] Today, tea gives work to many thousands of people in Sri Lanka, and the hills where it grows are famous around the world. **Visitors**[5] can stay in old houses on the tea farms **5: F** , walk between the bushes and watch the pluckers at work. They can also visit a factory to see how the tea is made, and then taste a fresh cup in a small café

with a view of the mountains. Many visitors say that tea tastes best in the place where it grew. Some farms now try to look after the land more carefully, so that the hills stay green for many years. For many Sri Lankans, a cup of tea is not just a drink. It is a part of their history.

Questions 1 to 5. Which paragraph contains the following information? Write the correct letter, A to F.

1. Why the **island** needed a **new crop** **B**

2. A story about **one man** who started **tea farming** **C**

3. The **work** that is done in a tea **factory** **E**

4. Why the **hills** are good for **growing tea** **D**

5. Things that **visitors** can do today **F**

Questions 6 to 10. Do the statements agree with the text? Write TRUE, FALSE or NOT GIVEN.

6. **Tea** has grown in Sri Lanka for **hundreds of years**. **FALSE**

7. A **disease** killed many of the **coffee plants**. **TRUE**

8. **James Taylor** came from **Scotland**. **TRUE**

9. **James Taylor** became rich because of **tea**. **NOT GIVEN**

10. **Machines** **pick** the tea leaves in Sri Lanka. **FALSE**

Questions 11 to 13. Complete the sentences. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the text.

11. **Pluckers** pick only the **youngest leaves** and a _____. **bud**

12. At first, the leaves lie in **large** _____ for **many hours**. **rooms**

13. The tea is sold at an **auction** in _____. **Colombo**

Questions 14 and 15. Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

14. What **happened** to the **coffee farms**?

A. They grew bigger

B. Nearly all of them failed

C. They made more money

D. They moved to Kandy

15. Why do people **pick** tea **by hand**?

A. Tea bushes are very small

B. It is cheaper than a factory

C. Machines cannot do the job well

D. Visitors like to watch